



SPONSOR: Rep. Wilson-Anton & Sen. Sturgeon
Reps. Minor-Brown, Bush, S. Moore; Sens. Sokola,
Hansen, Brown, Cruce, Hoffner, Huxtable, Lockman,
Mantzavinos, Paradee, Pinkney, Poore, Seigfried,
Townsend, Walsh

HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES
153rd GENERAL ASSEMBLY

HOUSE CONCURRENT RESOLUTION NO. 95

DESIGNATING JANUARY AS “MUSLIM HERITAGE MONTH” AND RECOGNIZING THE HOLY MONTH OF
RAMADAN AND MUSLIM RESIDENTS OF DELAWARE AS THEY OBSERVE RAMADAN.

1 WHEREAS, the State of Delaware takes great pride in the varied religious and cultural traditions of residents of
2 this State and seeks to afford all people in Delaware the opportunity to better understand, recognize, and appreciate the rich
3 histories, cultures, and shared principles of Muslim Americans; and

4 WHEREAS, Islam is one of the world’s major religions and part of our shared human heritage; and

5 WHEREAS, Muslims are the world’s second largest religious group, with 1.9 billion adherents, representing
6 approximately 25 percent of the world’s population; and

7 WHEREAS, Muslims have made significant contributions that shape our world, including notable achievements in
8 philosophy, mathematics, astronomy, physics, chemistry, medicine, architecture, music, literature, and the arts; and

9 WHEREAS, from the early days of European settlement to the present day, Muslim Americans have played a
10 significant role in the history of this State’s economic, cultural, spiritual, and political development; and

11 WHEREAS, there are several thousand Muslim Americans across this State, contributing to its economy, social
12 fabric, and multicultural and pluralistic traditions; and

13 WHEREAS, the 3.45 million Muslims in the United States come from diverse racial and ethnic backgrounds,
14 including immigrants and native-born Americans, and represent approximately 1.1 percent of the country’s population; and

15 WHEREAS, the history of Muslims in the United States dates back to before the country’s founding, originating
16 with enslaved Africans, of whom scholars estimate as many as 30 percent were Muslim, who brought Islamic beliefs and
17 practices with them and contributed in numerous ways to the founding of the nation, including courageous and dedicated
18 military service in every major war from the American Revolutionary War until today; and

19 WHEREAS, Muslim Americans strive to promote peace and mutual understanding between all faiths and
20 identities, while upholding the values and principles of Islam and those of the United States of America; and

21 WHEREAS, incidents of anti-Muslim violence and rhetoric are still prevalent in our State, and educational
22 initiatives are critical to combating bigotry; and

23 WHEREAS, the people of Delaware benefit from the social benevolence, patriotism, philanthropy,
24 humanitarianism, advocacy, civic engagement, culture, and business of Muslim Americans and Muslim American
25 organizations that operate within the State; and

26 WHEREAS, Ramadan is the ninth month of the Islamic calendar and is considered the holiest month of the year;
27 and

28 WHEREAS, Ramadan is on the Lunar calendar and this year will be observed from February 18th to March 20th;
29 and

30 WHEREAS, Ramadan is the month in which Muslims believe the Quran, the holy book of Islam, was revealed;
31 and

32 WHEREAS, Muslims fast during the entirety of the month of Ramadan, abstaining from food and drink from
33 sunrise to sunset; and

34 WHEREAS, many Muslims participate in nightly communal prayers called Taraweeh, in addition to the five daily
35 Islamic prayers; and

36 WHEREAS, Ramadan is a time to reflect spiritually, build communally, and aid those in need, and marks an
37 annual spiritual beginning for each individual – a reason to celebrate and express gratitude in this month; and

38 WHEREAS, during the month of Ramadan, all people are encouraged to reflect on past successes and challenges
39 of Muslims and look to the future to continue to improve our society so that we live up to our ideals of freedom, equality,
40 and justice; and

41 WHEREAS, as the month of Ramadan is observed, we must remember the critical importance of the respect that is
42 to be accorded to all faiths and beliefs as reflected in the First Amendment to the United States Constitution, which forbids
43 the making of any “law respecting an establishment of religion or prohibiting the free exercise of religion.”

44 NOW, THEREFORE:

45 BE IT RESOLVED by the House of Representatives of the 153rd General Assembly of the State of Delaware, the
46 Senate concurring therein, that the month of January of each year is designated as “Muslim Heritage Month” in the State of
47 Delaware.

48 BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the observance of the holy month of Ramadan as a month of fasting, sacrifice,
49 gratitude, and reflection, and the Muslim residents of this State who daily contribute to the betterment of this State and this
50 Nation, be recognized.

51 BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that the 153rd General Assembly encourages all Delawareans to join the General
52 Assembly in celebrating the collective ingenuity, creativity, cultures, and traditions of Muslim Americans, and commit
53 ourselves to raising awareness and appreciation of the month of Ramadan.

54 BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the 153rd General Assembly encourages all governments, schools, and
55 businesses throughout this State to extend religious accommodations, in accordance with existing law, to the many Muslim
56 residents, students, and workers of this State as they observe Ramadan through fasting, sacrifice, and reflection and as they
57 mark the end of Ramadan with celebratory festivities on the holiday known as Eid ul-Fitr.

SYNOPSIS

This Concurrent Resolution designates January as “Muslim Heritage Month” and recognizes Ramadan and Muslim residents of this State as they observe it.